

Different Effects of Time Use on Subjective Well-being by Gender and Life Stage



Ziyue “Davia” Dong
zy.dong@mail.utoronto.ca

Eric J. Miller
eric.miller@utoronto.ca

Introduction

Background

- Time use decisions, determining activity-travel patterns, are driven by personal and family needs, reflecting short-term goals and long-term aspirations.
- The decisions impact well-being, with variations across demographic groups.
- Few have integrated multiple dimensions of well-being while modelling both the direct and indirect effects of various time use activities.

Objectives

- How does time use across different activities influences various aspects of well-being?
- How do age and gender affect the significance attributed to different activities, which may reflect social or familial obligations that diverge from personal intrinsic preferences?

Data and Methods

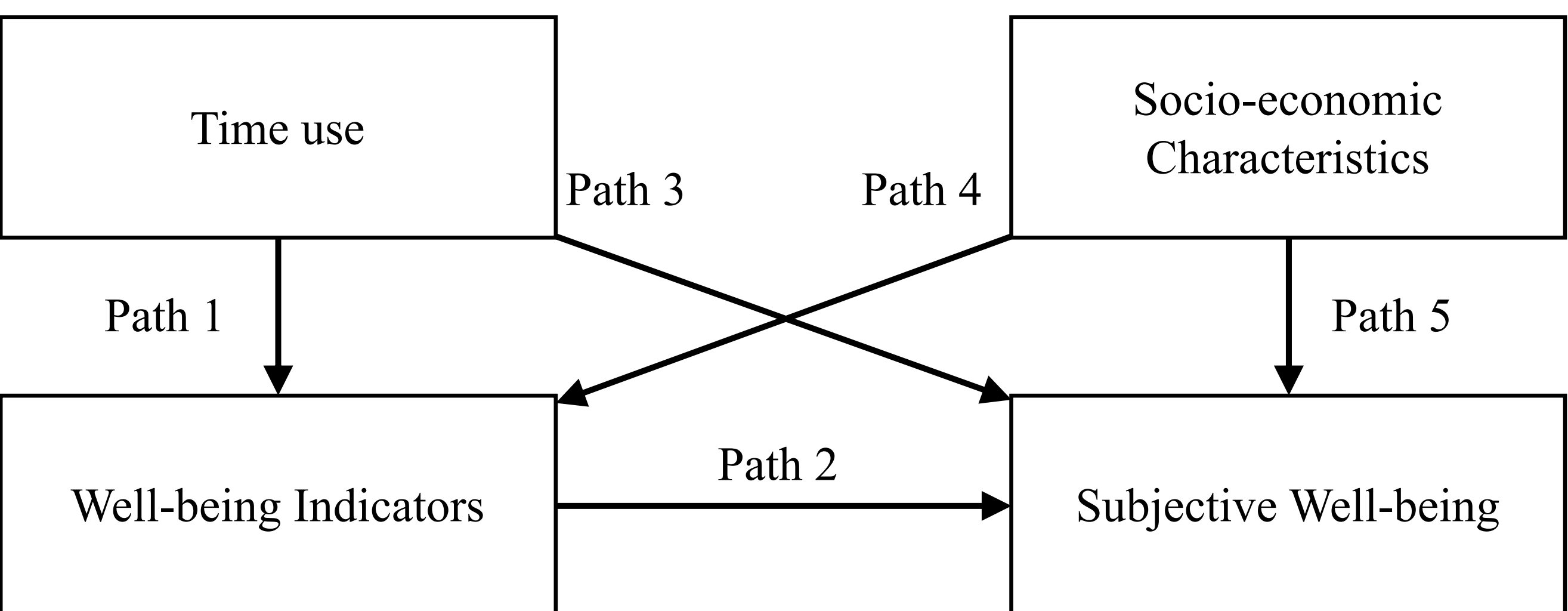


Figure 1: The proposed structural equation model framework.

- 2015 General Social Survey (GSG) on Time Use (Statistics Canada, 2017)

Structural Equation Model Results

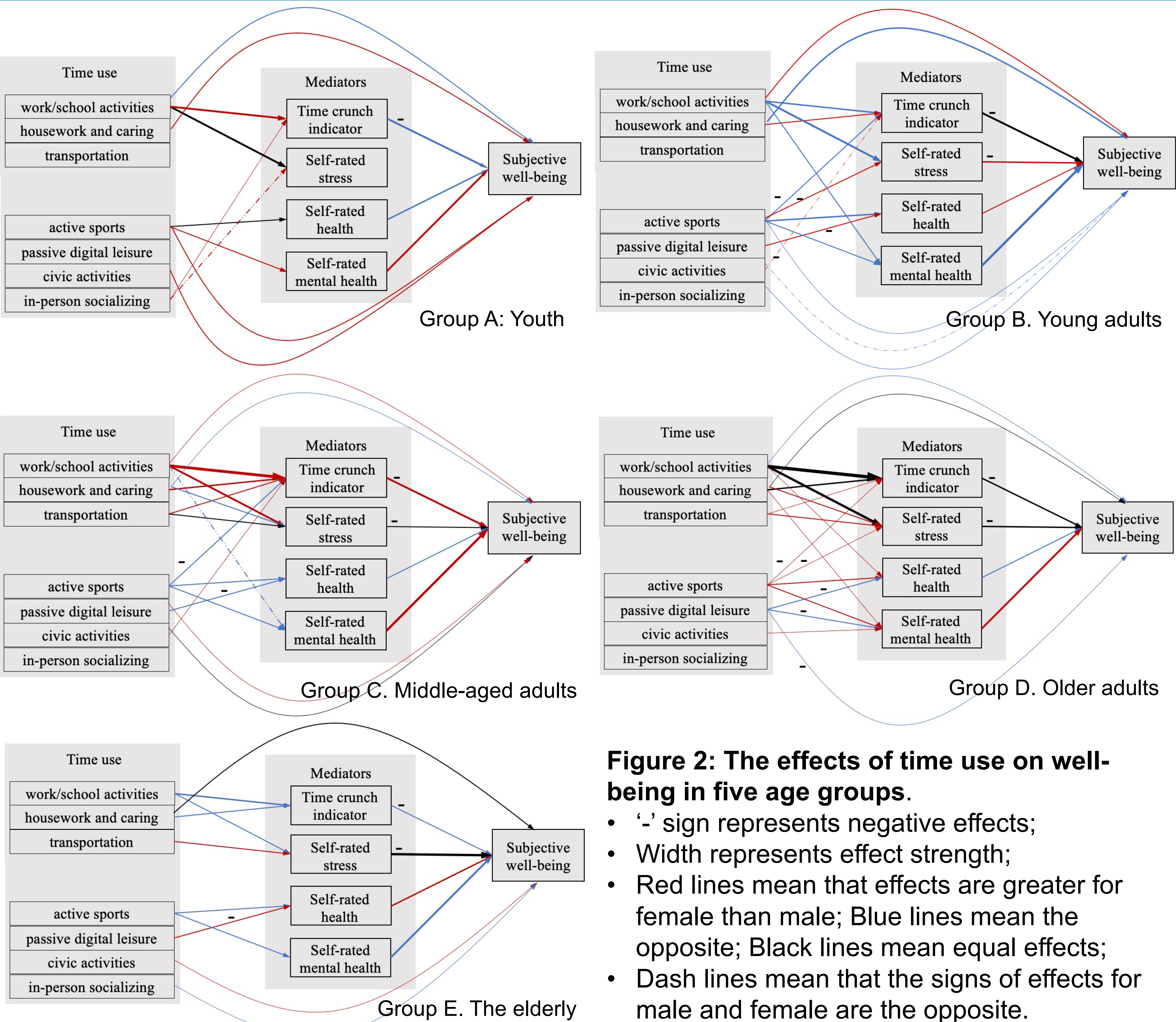


Figure 2: The effects of time use on well-being in five age groups.

- ‘-’ sign represents negative effects;
- Width represents effect strength;
- Red lines mean that effects are greater for female than male; Blue lines mean the opposite; Black lines mean equal effects;
- Dash lines mean that the signs of effects for male and female are the opposite.

Discussion

Conclusion

- Gendered divisions of labor persist in time use patterns and societal perceptions, despite shifts in gender roles.
- Men’s leisure time tends to rebound as children grow older, while women experience a more prolonged reduction.
- Different forms of leisure and social activities have varying impact on SWB for men and women.
- Time spent on transportation leads to time crunch and lower SWB particularly for middle-aged women and older adults.

Implications

- Social equity: address gender imbalances and challenge traditional norms to foster more equitable and fulfilling roles for individuals within families and society.
- Activity/travel modelling: understand time valuation and activity participation shifts across life stages, and potential dynamics as society evolves.

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